



HOW TO PLAY

keep the mind sharp

Start Here: A Friendly Brain Game Session

Who this is for

Activity directors, caregivers, and families who want a cheerful, no pressure way to keep minds active. Works one on one or with a group, and needs nothing but the printout and a good attitude.

How to lead it

Read slowly, give hints freely, and celebrate every answer. These are games, not tests. Aim for smiles and a few friendly debates. Twenty to thirty minutes is plenty for one session.

Keep it winning

Play in teams so nobody feels put on the spot. Offer the answer as a multiple choice if someone is stuck. The goal is a good time together, not a perfect score.





QUIZ

keep the mind sharp

General Knowledge Trivia

Read each question out loud and let the group answer together. Give hints when needed. One point per correct answer, and the leader key has all the answers.

1. How many days are there in a leap year?

.....

2. What is the largest ocean on Earth?

.....

3. How many legs does a spider have?

.....

4. What is the tallest animal in the world?

.....

5. What do bees collect from flowers to make honey?

.....

6. How many colors are there in a rainbow?

.....

7. What is the fastest land animal?

.....

8. What planet is known as the red planet?

.....

9. How many sides does a hexagon have?

.....

10. What is the hardest natural substance on Earth?

.....

11. What gas do plants breathe in that people breathe out?

.....

12. How many strings does a standard guitar have?

.....

13. What is the largest planet in our solar system?

.....

14. What is the main ingredient in bread?

.....





HOW TO PLAY

keep the mind sharp

General Knowledge Trivia: Leader Answer Key

Answers 1 to 7

1. 366. 2. The Pacific. 3. Eight. 4. The giraffe. 5. Nectar. 6. Seven. 7. The cheetah.

Answers 8 to 14

8. Mars. 9. Six. 10. Diamond. 11. Carbon dioxide. 12. Six. 13. Jupiter. 14. Flour.





QUIZ

keep the mind sharp **True or False**

Read each statement and let the group vote true or false, then reveal the answer. A relaxed, no pressure game that always sparks a little friendly argument.

1. A tomato is a fruit. True or false?

.....

2. The sun rises in the west. True or false?

.....

3. Penguins can fly. True or false?

.....

4. Honey never spoils. True or false?

.....

5. There are eight days in a week. True or false?

.....

6. A shrimp's heart is in its head. True or false?

.....

7. Bananas grow underground. True or false?

.....

8. The human body has more than two hundred bones. True or false?

.....

9. An octopus has three hearts. True or false?

.....

10. Goldfish can only remember things for three seconds. True or false?

.....

11. Water boils at one hundred degrees Celsius at sea level. True or false?

.....

12. Cows can walk down stairs but not up. True or false?

.....





HOW TO PLAY

keep the mind sharp

True or False: Leader Answer Key

Answers 1 to 6

1. True. 2. False, it rises in the east. 3. False, they swim. 4. True. 5. False, seven. 6. True.

Answers 7 to 12

7. False, they grow on a large plant. 8. True, about two hundred and six. 9. True. 10. False, a myth, their memory lasts months. 11. True. 12. False, a common myth, they can do both.





QUIZ

keep the mind sharp

Complete the Famous Pair

These things go together. Read the first and let the group call out the second. Warm, quick, and always good for a laugh. Answers on the leader key.

1. Salt and...

.....

2. Fish and...

.....

3. Bread and...

.....

4. Cup and...

.....

5. Knife and...

.....

6. Thunder and...

.....

7. Needle and...

.....

8. Bacon and...

.....

9. Sun and...

.....

10. Peaches and...

.....

11. Shoes and...

.....

12. Bride and...

.....

13. Cats and...

.....

14. Pen and...

.....





HOW TO PLAY

keep the mind sharp

Complete the Famous Pair: Leader Answer Key

Answers 1 to 7

1. Pepper. 2. Chips. 3. Butter. 4. Saucer. 5. Fork. 6. Lightning. 7. Thread.

Answers 8 to 14

8. Eggs. 9. Moon. 10. Cream. 11. Socks. 12. Groom. 13. Dogs. 14. Paper.





GROUP GAME

keep the mind sharp

Name Ten In This Category

Read a category and go around the group naming things that fit. See if the group can reach ten. A cheerful way to get everyone talking and thinking together.

- | | |
|--|---|
| ☐ Name ten fruits | ☐ Name ten breakfast foods |
| ☐ Name ten farm animals | ☐ Name ten musical instruments |
| ☐ Name ten things you would find in a kitchen | ☐ Name ten things in a garden |
| ☐ Name ten colors | ☐ Name ten jobs people do |
| ☐ Name ten types of flower | ☐ Name ten things that are round |
| ☐ Name ten things that are cold | ☐ Name ten sweet treats |
| ☐ Name ten kinds of weather | ☐ Name ten birds |
| ☐ Name ten items of clothing | ☐ Name ten things at the seaside |
| ☐ Name ten things with wheels | ☐ Name ten tools |
| ☐ Name ten things you take on holiday | ☐ Name ten board or card games |





QUIZ

keep the mind sharp **Odd One Out**

Read each group of four out loud. The group decides which one does not belong and why. There is often more than one good answer, so enjoy the discussion. Leader key gives the intended answer.

1. Apple, banana, carrot, orange. Which is the odd one out?

.....

2. Dog, cat, goldfish, elephant. Which is the odd one out?

.....

3. Rose, daisy, oak, tulip. Which is the odd one out?

.....

4. Car, bicycle, boat, motorcycle. Which is the odd one out?

.....

5. Monday, July, Friday, Sunday. Which is the odd one out?

.....

6. Piano, guitar, violin, drum. Which is the odd one out?

.....

7. Tea, coffee, milk, lemonade. Which is the odd one out?

.....

8. Circle, square, triangle, cube. Which is the odd one out?

.....

9. Rain, snow, sun, wind. Which is the odd one out?

.....

10. Shoe, hat, glove, scarf. Which is the odd one out?

.....

11. Spring, summer, morning, winter. Which is the odd one out?

.....

12. Robin, sparrow, bat, eagle. Which is the odd one out?

.....





HOW TO PLAY

keep the mind sharp

Odd One Out: Leader Answer Key

Answers 1 to 6

1. Carrot, it is a vegetable. 2. Elephant, it is not a house pet. 3. Oak, it is a tree not a flower. 4. Boat, it has no wheels. 5. July, it is a month not a day. 6. Drum, the others have strings.

Answers 7 to 12

7. Milk, the others are made with water. 8. Cube, it is three dimensional. 9. Sun, the others are wet or windy weather. 10. Shoe, the others are worn above the waist. 11. Morning, the others are seasons. 12. Bat, it is a mammal not a bird. Accept any well reasoned answer.





THIS OR THAT

keep the mind sharp

Which Would You Choose

Read each pair and ask the group which they would pick. There are no wrong answers. A gentle way to hear opinions and start a story.

A day at the beach *or* A day in the countryside

Tea *or* Coffee

Summer *or* Winter

A good book *or* A good film

Cooking *or* Being cooked for

Cats *or* Dogs

Mountains *or* The sea

Sweet *or* Savory

Morning *or* Evening

A quiet night in *or* A lively night out

Singing *or* Dancing

The city *or* The country

Roses *or* Sunflowers

A train journey *or* A road trip

Chocolate *or* Fruit

Reading the news *or* Doing the crossword





QUIZ

keep the mind sharp

Finish the Proverb

Read the start of each well known proverb and let the group finish it. Then talk about what each one means. A warm way to end the session. Answers on the leader key.

1. Look before you...

.....

2. Practice makes...

.....

3. Honesty is the best...

.....

4. All that glitters is not...

.....

5. The apple does not fall far from the...

.....

6. Where there is a will there is a...

.....

7. Two wrongs do not make a...

.....

8. A watched pot never...

.....

9. When in Rome do as the...

.....

10. You reap what you...

.....

11. Absence makes the heart grow...

.....

12. Do unto others as you would have them do unto...

.....





HOW TO PLAY

keep the mind sharp

Finish the Proverb: Leader Answer Key

Answers 1 to 6

1. Leap. 2. Perfect. 3. Policy. 4. Gold. 5. Tree. 6. Way.

Answers 7 to 12

7. Right. 8. Boils. 9. Romans do. 10. Sow. 11. Fonder. 12. You.

